ChatGPT 5 Thinking mini

Please identify 5 roles in the entertainment and media fields that require a high degree of knowledge around digital product management with a technical understanding of backend web development. In my career, see my linked in https://www.linkedin.com/in/ddemakes , I've done a lot of work with software development teams, but I could not look at their code and understand what it's doing. I am currently in a 6 month course for backend web development. The goal of the program is for students to find and entry level position in the industry. Since I have 30 years experience in media and digital product development in the media space, I would like to leverage that skill set while utilizing my new found skills. So, any role you select should be product first, with a technical bent. Not expert technical bent, but some better understanding than non-technical product managers. Please review my linkedin, and ask me 5 questions that would better help you generate a list of job roles in media and entertainment companies.

Quick note

I tried to open your LinkedIn profile at the URL you gave but the page blocked automated access (robots.txt). N/A I can still proceed using the background I already have about your career and the goals you described — or you can paste your LinkedIn summary / most relevant bullets and I'll use that for a tighter match.

Below are five product-first roles in entertainment & media that fit someone with ~30 years in media/digital product plus growing backend development skills. After the roles I'll ask five targeted questions that will help me tailor a short list of specific job titles and target companies.

Five product-first roles (technical bent)

1. **Technical Product Manager — Streaming / OTT Platforms**
   Owns product features for video ingestion, playback, DRM, and scaling for a streaming service. Needs to translate business goals (engagement, monetization) into backend priorities (CDN, transcoding, APIs) and comfortably read engineering trade-offs. Good fit if you want to leverage media distribution experience and learn backend stacks used in media pipelines.
2. **Platform / Core Product Manager — CMS & Publishing Systems**
   Focuses on content pipelines, editorial tools, publishing workflows, and APIs that power news or entertainment properties. Requires product-first thinking about editorial UX and a working understanding of backend concepts (datastores, indexing, background jobs) so you can scope technical effort and prioritize platform stability.
3. **Ad-Tech Product Manager (Server-Side & Programmatic)**
   Owns server-to-server ad-serving features, bidding integrations, and analytics. Needs to understand backend latency, request flows, data schemas, and measurement systems while driving product requirements that improve yield for publishers and targeting for advertisers. Leverages your media revenue experience.
4. **Data / Personalization Product Manager (Recommendations & ML Ops)**
   Responsible for productizing content-recommendation systems, A/B experimentation, and the pipelines that feed models (ETL, feature stores, batch vs streaming). Product-first role that benefits from knowing how recommendations impact engagement and basic backend concepts so you can prioritize model-to-product delivery.
5. **API / Integration Product Manager — Distribution & Partnerships**
   Owns public/private APIs, partner integrations (e.g., device SDKs, third-party platforms), and developer experience. Requires product judgment about partner value and enough backend understanding (auth, rate-limiting, versioning) to set SLAs and plan releases that third parties can integrate against.

Why these fit you (brief)

- They are explicitly product-first: strategy, roadmaps, stakeholder alignment, and user/market outcomes drive decisions.
- Each benefits from domain knowledge in media (content pipelines, monetization, distribution) that you already have.

- They require more technical fluency than a purely non-technical PM (so your backend course will be directly useful) but not deep software-engineer-level mastery.

Five questions to tailor job-role matches

1. Which backend technologies/languages are you studying now (e.g., Node.js, Python, Java, SQL, Docker/k8s)?
2. Do you want to be hands-on coding occasionally (15–30% of time) or purely product/strategy (no coding expected)?
3. Which media subdomains excite you most: streaming/video, publishing/news, advertising/monetization, games, or data/personalization?
4. Are you targeting entry-level engineering-adjacent roles (e.g., Associate Technical PM) or product roles that expect senior product experience but junior coding ability?
5. What company size and culture do you prefer (startup / scaleup, mid-market, large legacy media/streaming firm), and are you open to remote roles?

If you want, paste one paragraph from your LinkedIn (headline + 2–3 summary bullets) and I'll regenerate the five roles and target job titles (including suggested companies and keywords to use on job sites) tailored exactly to your profile. Which would you prefer?

Profile.pdf
PDF

Here is my linkedin profile. Please identify 5 roles in the entertainment and media fields that require a high degree of knowledge around digital product management with a technical understanding of backend web development. In my career, see my linkedin profile pdf attached, I've done a lot of work with software development teams, but I could not look at their code and understand what it's doing. I am currently in a 6 month course for backend web development. The goal of the program is for

students to find and entry level position in the industry. Since I have 30 years experience in media and digital product development in the media space, I would like to leverage that skill set while utilizing my new found skills. So, any role you select should be product first, with a technical bent. Not expert technical bent, but some better understanding than non-technical product managers. Please review my linkedin, and ask me 5 questions that would better help you generate a list of job roles in media and entertainment companies.

Thought for 7s >

Thanks — I reviewed your LinkedIn PDF. Profile Below are five product-first roles in entertainment & media that require a stronger-than-average technical understanding of backend web development (but not deep software-engineer mastery). For each role I list the core responsibilities, the backend concepts you should be comfortable with, the realistic "entry path" given your background, and why it maps to your experience.

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1 — Technical Product Manager, Streaming / OTT Features

What you own: product strategy and roadmaps for streaming features (playback, adaptive bitrate, DRM, offline downloads, device integrations).
Backend fluency needed: REST APIs, CDNs, transcoding pipelines, manifest formats (HLS/DASH), authentication/authorization, basic performance/latency tradeoffs.
Entry path (given your background): Associate/Technical PM → PM for a feature (ingest/transcode) → Senior TPM. Emphasize your mobile + video product launches.
Why it fits you: your work launching digital video and mobile experiences (A&E, Disney) directly translates to product judgment about content delivery and playback quality. A&E Television Networks Walt Disney Internet Group

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2 — Platform Product Manager — CMS / Editorial & Publishing Systems

What you own: editorial workflows, content APIs, publishing pipelines, scheduling, asset management and integrations with front-end apps/devices.
Backend fluency needed: databases (SQL/noSQL), job queues/background workers, REST/GraphQL APIs, search/indexing (Elasticsearch or similar), content modeling.
Entry path: Product Owner / PM for platform features → Platform PM. Your municipal CMS migration and editorial training work makes you credible to editorial stakeholders.
Why it fits you: you've run content migrations, CMS projects and editorial training for public-facing sites — that domain knowledge + new backend skills is exactly what platform teams need.

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3 — Ad-Tech / Revenue Product Manager (server-side ad delivery & measurement)

What you own: server-side ad flows, measurement & reporting, header-bidding/server-to-server integrations, yield optimization features.
Backend fluency needed: request/response flows, latency budgeting, event logging, data pipelines (ETL), schema design for metrics.
Entry path: Product Analyst → Associate PM on monetization → Ad-tech PM. Your prior media revenue/product roles (publisher relationships, monetization at Nokia/A&E) are a direct advantage. Nokia

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4 — Data & Personalization Product Manager (recommendation pipelines)

What you own: productization of recommendation/Personalization features — A/B testing, offline vs real-time features, experiment design, and model deployment workflows.
Backend fluency needed: batch vs stream processing, feature pipelines, model feature stores, metrics ingestion, instrumentation for experiments.
Entry path: Product Analyst or PM for experimentation → Personalization PM. Emphasize product outcomes (engagement lift) you drove historically.
Why it fits you: your experience linking product decisions to audience outcomes

positions you to translate ML/engineering tradeoffs into product experiments and KPI improvements.

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5 — API / Partner Integrations Product Manager (device SDKs, partner APIs)

What you own: public/private APIs, partner onboarding, SDK contracts, versioning, SLAs, developer experience & docs.
Backend fluency needed: API design, auth (OAuth/jwt), rate limiting, versioning strategy, observability for integrations.
Entry path: Technical PM for partner integrations → API Product Manager. Your history liaising with developer publishers and platform partners maps well here (Nokia App Store liaison work is directly relevant). Nokia

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How to position yourself for interviews (short checklist)

- Highlight product outcomes (engagement, revenue, scale) from your Disney/Nokia/A&E projects rather than implementation details. Walt Disney Internet Group
- Show concrete backend familiarity: be able to explain what a REST API is, what a CDN does, the difference between batch vs streaming ETL, and why latency matters for ads/streaming.
- Prepare a 2–3 minute "bridge story" describing a product decision you led, the engineering tradeoffs you negotiated, and what you learned—this demonstrates product intuition + technical empathy.
- Look for job titles like *Associate Technical Product Manager, Technical Product Manager (Streaming/Platform/Monetization), Product Manager — API/Integrations, Product Manager — Personalization*.

Five questions to refine and tailor suggested roles & titles

1. Which backend technologies are you learning right now (e.g., Node.js/Express, Python/Flask or Django, SQL, Postgres, Redis, Docker)?

2. How much hands-on coding do you want in a new role (never, occasionally 5–15%, regularly 15–30%)?
3. Which media subdomains excite you most (streaming/video, publishing/news, ad-tech, games, live events, interactive experiences)?
4. Are you targeting an *entry-level engineering-adjacent* role (e.g., Associate Technical PM) or a *product role that expects senior product experience but junior coding ability* (i.e., lateral product hire)?
5. What's your preferred company size and working model (startup/scaleup with broad hands-on work, mid-market, legacy large media/streamer — and remote vs hybrid vs local)?

If you want, answer those five questions and I'll return: (A) a prioritized shortlist of 6–8 exact job titles to apply for, (B) three tailored resume bullets that translate specific items from your LinkedIn PDF into technical-product language, and (C) 5 targeted keywords to use on job sites.

Sources

Please fill this out with 1 or 2 sentences after each bulleted item. Use the role information below the questions to answer.
1. Job Title and Summary
- What is the role called?
- Write a short 2-3 sentence summary that explains what the role does and why it exists.
2. Responsibilities
- List 5-7 tasks or duties this role performs regularly.
- Example: "Maintain backend systems using Node.js," "Respond to cybersecurity alerts."
3. Required Skills and Tools
What programming languages, tools, platforms, or soft

skills are essential for this job?
- Example: Python, Linux, teamwork, Git.
4. Sample Deliverables
- What kind of work or projects would someone in this job create or be responsible for?
- Example: incident report, API endpoint, dashboard.
5. Ideal Work Environment
- What kind of company is this job at? (startup, nonprofit, large tech?)
- What is the work style? (independent, team-based, structured?)
6. Growth Style and Rigor
- How fast-paced or intense is the work?
- Is there mentorship, structure, freedom, or pressure?

ROLE INFORMATION
Technical Product Manager — Streaming / OTT Features

Own the product strategy and roadmap for core streaming capabilities: playback, adaptive bitrate, DRM, offline downloads, and device integrations. My work launching digital video and mobile experiences at A&E Television Networks and Walt Disney Internet Group directly translates to sharp product judgment about content delivery and playback quality.

What I'll Own
Playback quality & adaptive bitrate (ABR) strategy
DRM, offline downloads, device integrations
Transcoding pipelines and manifest formats (HLS/DASH)

Backend Fluency Needed
REST APIs, CDNs, transcoding pipelines
Authentication / authorization flows
Performance and latency tradeoffs

Entry Path
Associate/Technical PM → PM for ingest/transcode feature → Senior TPM. Lean hard into mobile + video

launch experience.

Where to Apply — Technical PM, Streaming / OTT

NYC companies
NBCUniversal / Peacock — Technical PM roles for streaming platform and playback features
Paramount+ — Connected TV and OTT product team, Sr. Technical PM
Warner Bros. Discovery (Max) — Streaming infrastructure and device integration PM roles
Vimeo — Video platform PM, API and playback experience
FreeWheel (Comcast) — Ad-tech and video streaming platform PM

Los Angeles companies
Netflix — Streaming platform and mobile product PM roles (LA HQ)
Tubi (Fox Corporation) — Content platform and streaming infrastructure PM
Paramount+ — Burbank office, Sr. Tech PM for content and OTT
Disney Streaming — Device integrations and playback PM (Burbank/LA)
Xumo (Comcast) — Technical PM for video streaming platform (Irvine/LA area)

Thought for 6s ›

1. Job Title and Summary

- **What is the role called?**
  Technical Product Manager — Streaming / OTT Features.
- **Summary (1–2 sentences):**
  Owns the product strategy and roadmap for core streaming capabilities like playback, adaptive bitrate, DRM, offline downloads, and device integrations. This role exists to translate business goals for content delivery and user experience into prioritized backend work that keeps streams reliable, performant, and monetizable.

2. Responsibilities

- **Define and prioritize feature roadmaps for playback and device support.**
  Create and maintain a roadmap that balances user experience improvements, platform compatibility, and engineering effort for playback, ABR, and offline features.
- **Specify technical requirements and acceptance criteria for backend features.**
  Write clear product requirements (APIs, manifest behavior, auth flows, latency targets) that engineering can implement and QA can validate.
- **Coordinate cross-functional launches with engineering, QA, and platform partners.**
  Manage release plans, device certification, and rollouts to ensure new streaming features deploy smoothly across apps and devices.
- **Monitor performance, incidents, and SLA metrics for streaming systems.**
  Track key telemetry (startup time, rebuffer rate, CDN errors) and drive engineering work to meet reliability and latency targets.
- **Partner with infrastructure and media pipeline teams on transcoding and CDN strategies.**
  Prioritize encoding profiles, manifest formats, and CDN configurations to optimize quality and cost across devices and networks.
- **Own DRM, security, and authentication product decisions.**
  Define how content protection and offline licenses should behave, weighing user friction against rights-holder requirements.
- **Engage with product stakeholders and business teams to align monetization and UX.**
  Translate marketing, content, and analytics inputs into product tradeoffs that affect retention and revenue.

3. Required Skills and Tools

- **Technical / platforms:**
  Familiarity with REST APIs, CDN concepts, HLS/DASH manifest basics, transcoding pipelines, and authentication flows (OAuth/JWT); working knowledge of cloud services (e.g., object storage, CDN, media transcode jobs) and basic SQL for instrumentation queries.

- **Engineering collaboration tools:**
  Comfortable using GitHub/Jira for backlog management, Postman for API checks, and observability tooling (Datadog, Grafana, or similar) to interpret streaming metrics.
- **Soft skills:**
  Strong stakeholder communication, prioritization and trade-off decision making, ability to write precise acceptance criteria, and empathy for both editorial/business and engineering teams.

4. Sample Deliverables

- **Feature spec and API contract for adaptive bitrate and manifest behavior.**
- **Release plan and runbook for a device-integration rollout (including certification checklist).**
- **Monitoring dashboards showing startup time, rebuffer rate, and CDN error rates, plus post-release incident summaries.**
- **Product requirements for offline downloads and license expiration behavior, with acceptance tests.**
- **Business case and roadmap slice that quantifies engagement/revenue impact from a streaming feature (e.g., lower rebuffering → higher retention).**

5. Ideal Work Environment

- **Company type:**
  Best at mid-to-large streaming services, OTT platforms, or video-platform product teams where cross-functional dependencies and scale matter.
- **Work style:**
  Highly team-based and collaborative—you'll work closely with backend engineers, SRE, QA, content ops, and analytics teams—within a structured product process but with tactical autonomy to make tradeoffs.

6. Growth Style and Rigor

- **Pace and intensity:**
  Moderately to highly fast-paced with tight SLAs (playback and ad latency are time-sensitive), especially around large launches or peak traffic windows.
- **Mentorship and structure:**
  Expect a mix: formal mentorship and clear career paths at larger orgs, hands-on

learning and broader scope at smaller teams; success requires operational rigor, incident readiness, and continuous learning of backend concepts.

Please fill this out with 1 or 2 sentences after each bulleted item. Use the role information below the questions to answer, BUT FILL THIS OUT REGARDING AN ENTRY LEVEL POSITION WHICH WOULD LEAD TO THE ROLE OF TECHNICAL PRODUCT MANAGER. 1. Job Title and Summary - What is the role called? - Write a short 2-3 sentence summary that explains what the role does and why it exists. 2. Responsibilities - List 5-7 tasks or duties this role performs regularly. - Example: "Maintain backend systems using Node.js," "Respond to cybersecurity alerts." 3. Required Skills and Tools What programming languages, tools, platforms, or soft skills are essential for this job? - Example: Python, Linux, teamwork, Git. 4. Sample Deliverables - What kind of work or projects would someone in this job create or be responsible for? - Example: incident report, API endpoint, dashboard. 5. Ideal Work Environment - What kind of company is this job at? (startup, nonprofit, large tech?) - What is the work style? (independent, team-based, structured?) 6. Growth Style and Rigor - How fast-paced or intense is the work? - Is there mentorship, structure, freedom, or pressure? ROLE INFORMATION Technical Product Manager — Streaming / OTT Features Own the product strategy and roadmap for core streaming capabilities: playback, adaptive bitrate, DRM, offline downloads, and device integrations. My work launching digital video and mobile experiences at A&E Television Networks and Walt Disney Internet Group directly translates to sharp product judgment about content delivery and playback quality. What I'll Own Playback quality & adaptive bitrate (ABR) strategy DRM, offline downloads, device integrations Transcoding pipelines and manifest formats (HLS/DASH) Backend Fluency Needed REST APIs, CDNs, transcoding pipelines

Authentication / authorization flows Performance and latency tradeoffs Entry Path Associate/Technical PM → PM for ingest/transcode feature → Senior TPM. Lean hard into mobile + video launch experience. Where to Apply — Technical PM, Streaming / OTT NYC companies NBCUniversal / Peacock — Technical PM roles for streaming platform and playback features Paramount+ — Connected TV and OTT product team, Sr. Technical PM Warner Bros. Discovery (Max) — Streaming infrastructure and device integration PM roles Vimeo — Video platform PM, API and playback experience FreeWheel (Comcast) — Ad-tech and video streaming platform PM Los Angeles companies Netflix — Streaming platform and mobile product PM roles (LA HQ) Tubi (Fox Corporation) — Content platform and streaming infrastructure PM Paramount+ — Burbank office, Sr. Tech PM for content and OTT Disney Streaming — Device integrations and playback PM (Burbank/LA) Xumo (Comcast) — Technical PM for video streaming platform (Irvine/LA area)

Thought for 4 seconds ›

1. Job Title and Summary

- **What is the role called?**
  Associate Technical Product Manager — Streaming (Entry Level). This title signals a product-first role with a technical mentorship path toward a full Technical Product Manager.
- **Summary:**
  The Associate TPM supports the streaming product team by specifying feature requirements, tracking metrics, and coordinating engineering and QA for playback, ABR, DRM, and device work. It exists to translate product goals into implementable backend tasks while the hire gains hands-on familiarity with media pipelines and operational telemetry.

2. Responsibilities

- **Help write clear product requirements and acceptance criteria for playback and ingest features.**

Work with senior PMs and engineers to convert product needs (e.g., lower rebuffer rate) into API/manifest specs and testable acceptance criteria.

- **Manage tickets and the sprint backlog for small feature slices.**
  Triage bugs, create user stories, and ensure tasks have the required context, mockups, and test cases so engineers can move quickly.
- **Monitor basic streaming telemetry and report on key metrics.**
  Pull startup time, rebuffering, and CDN error rates from dashboards and produce short summaries that highlight regressions or improvement opportunities.
- **Coordinate cross-functional QA and device certification tasks for releases.**
  Own test-checklists, device test results, and the rollout schedule so releases meet platform and DRM requirements.
- **Assist in investigating incidents and creating post-mortems.**
  Gather logs, timeline events, and stakeholder notes; help document root causes and recommended follow-ups.
- **Support partner & platform onboarding activities (SDK/device checks).**
  Help run integration tests, validate API responses, and maintain simple onboarding documentation for partners.
- **Learn and document media pipeline basics (transcoding, manifests, CDN behavior).**
  Maintain a personal and team “cheat sheet” that maps backend components to product outcomes to accelerate technical fluency.

3. Required Skills and Tools

- **Foundational backend familiarity (Node/Python basics, SQL).**
  Able to read short code snippets and run simple queries to verify data; this supports meaningful conversations with engineers and basic troubleshooting.
- **Product & collaboration tools (Jira, GitHub, Postman).**
  Comfortable creating/triaging issues in Jira, reading PR titles in GitHub, and using Postman to validate API responses.
- **Observability & analytics (Datadog/Grafana, basic SQL for metrics).**
  Able to read dashboards, set a simple alert, and run a SQL query to pull a metric for a team update.
- **Media-specific concepts (HLS/DASH basics, CDN, transcode pipeline awareness).**

Understands what a manifest is, why transcoding profiles matter, and the role CDNs play in playback quality.

- **Soft skills: clear written specs, stakeholder communication, prioritization.**
  Strong at writing concise acceptance criteria, aligning engineers and content teams, and making tradeoffs visible to stakeholders.

4. Sample Deliverables

- **User story + acceptance criteria for an ABR improvement spike.**
  A one-page ticket that describes the problem, success metrics, test cases, and rollout steps.
- **Release checklist & runbook for a small playback feature.**
  A document listing device tests, DRM validation steps, monitoring queries, and rollback instructions.
- **Monitoring snapshot and short analysis note on rebuffering trends.**
  A dashboard screenshot with a 1–2 paragraph interpretation and recommended next actions.
- **API smoke test collection (Postman) for ingest or playback endpoints.**
  A runnable collection that QA and partners can use to validate integrations.
- **Incident timeline and draft post-mortem for a playback outage.**
  A factual timeline, impact summary, and 2–3 remediation actions for the engineering team.

5. Ideal Work Environment

- **Company type:**
  Best at mid-sized streaming teams, video-platform companies, or the streaming/product teams inside larger media companies where you can learn from senior TPMs and SREs.
- **Work style:**
  Team-based with structured processes (sprints, defined QA gates) and regular pairing with senior PMs and engineers to accelerate learning and impact.

6. Growth Style and Rigor

- **Pace and intensity:**
  Moderately fast — cadence is sprint-driven with occasional high-pressure windows

around major releases or peak events, but most work is predictable and milestone-based.

- **Mentorship and advancement:**
  Strong mentorship: expect frequent reviews, pairing on technical topics, and a clear path (Associate TPM → Technical PM) that rewards mastering backend concepts, driving small releases, and improving operational metrics.

Ask me 5 questions before you answer.
I'm enrolled in a course for backend web development. I need 3 ideas for projects which will take 120 hours to complete while learning the basics of backend web development. The course teaches while you build. I am focused on the job description "Technical Product Manager". The three project ideas must focus on some aspect of that job which would show evidence of a technical understanding of the types of tasks a worker would encounter in that position in order to show proficiency and an understanding of what the role entails. I'd like to take this approach: 1 - find 10 job postings with the title " Technical Product Manager" in streaming media industry anywhere in the world, remote jobs included. 2 - compile all job tasks & responsibilities. 3 - Analyze all tasks & responsibilities across the job postings and determine the top 10 most common. 4 - create five projects that can be completed within 120 hours over 3 month's time that illustrate evidence of a technical understanding of the task or responsibilities a worker would encounter in that position in order to show proficiency and an understanding of what the role entails. 5 - as part of each project, generate a short paragraph explaining which task or responsibilities the project aligns, desired outcome, technology required, tools required and show which are free and which are paid, list any certifications which would be helpful to accomplish

the project. Remember to ask me 5 questions before you answer.

Thought for a few seconds ›

Great — five quick questions so I tailor the 120-hour project plan precisely to your goals.

1. Do you want me to search the web now for the 10 “Technical Product Manager” streaming/OTT job postings (I’ll gather them and analyze), or will you provide the postings/links?
2. Which backend stack are you currently learning or prefer to use for these projects (e.g., **Node.js/Express**, **Python/Flask or Django**, **Go**, **Postgres/MySQL**, **Redis**, Docker)?
3. How many hours per week can you reliably commit over the next 3 months (so I can break 120 hours into realistic sprints)?
4. What final deliverables do you want for each project (public GitHub repo, deployed demo, README + design doc, slide deck, short video walkthrough, or resume-ready one-pager)?
5. Any constraints or preferences for tools/hosting and budget (free-only services, permitted paid services such as AWS/Azure/GCP credits, or requirement to avoid company-paid tools)?

Answer those and I’ll produce: the job-posting analysis, the top 10 tasks, and three (actually five per your earlier ask) 120-hour project plans with outcomes, tech/tool lists (free vs paid), and suggested certs.

1 You find job postings. | 2 MERN, but I can adjust where it's not too costly. | 3 Project work starts Week 14 and ends Week 26 so 12 weeks in total. Work days are Monday-Thursday 2 hour each day, so, it's actually 96 hours, not 120. | 4 All of the above. | 5 I'd prefer free, unless absolutely necessary to have to pay for a tool or service.

Thought for 35s >

Nice — thanks for the answers. I used them (you asked me to find the job postings) and built everything around a MERN-friendly, low-cost workflow and your 12-week / 96-hour calendar (Mon–Thu, 2 hrs/day). Below I deliver:

1. the 10 streaming-industry job postings I found,
2. the top-10 tasks/responsibilities synthesized from those postings (what hiring teams actually ask for), and
3. five **entry-level, 96-hour** project plans (each fits your weekly cadence) that map directly to the Technical Product Manager role and prove technical fluency — each project includes alignment to job tasks, desired outcome, tech & tools (free vs paid), certifications that help, and a week-by-week schedule.

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1) Ten streaming / video job postings I retrieved

(These are representative Technical / Senior Technical Product Manager listings from streaming & video companies I used to build the task analysis.)

- Dolby Laboratories, Inc. — **Sr. Technical Product Manager — OTT**. jobs.dolby.com
- Paramount+ — **Senior Technical Product Manager — Content / Platform**. careers.paramou... +1
- NBCUniversal — **Technical Product Manager — AdSales BI / Data**. builtinnyc.com +1
- Warner Bros. Discovery — **Senior Staff Technical Product Manager — Live / Global Video Platform**. showbizjobs.com +1
- Netflix — **Product Manager / Technical Product Manager — infra / cloud & platform**. explore.jobs.netfl... +1
- Tubi — **Senior Technical Product Manager — Backend Services**. startup.jobs
- Roku — **Product Manager — Ads & Platform (technical emphasis)**. linkedin.com
- Vimeo — **Sr Product Manager / Platform (device + events)**. careervault.io
- Xumo — **Technical Product Manager / PM (device + platform)**. LinkedIn
- FreeWheel (Comcast) — **Technical Product Manager / Measurement & AdTech** (listings under Comcast/FreeWheel). Built In NYC +1

I used these postings as the source set to extract task language and responsibilities for the synthesis below. (Citations above are the primary job pages / job-list

aggregates I consulted.)

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2) Top 10 common tasks / responsibilities across those Technical Product Manager postings

(Condensed from the job descriptions above — these are the tasks hiring teams repeatedly list.)

1. **Define & prioritize product roadmaps for streaming/platform features** (playback, ABR, device support). careers.paramou... +1
2. **Write technical requirements / API contracts / acceptance criteria** for backend features and partner integrations. Startup Jobs +1
3. **Coordinate cross-functional launches** (engineering, QA, device partners, content ops). Built In NYC +1
4. **Monitor operational telemetry & SLAs** (startup time, rebuffer rates, CDN errors, latency) and drive remediation. jobs.dolby.com +1
5. **Manage APIs, partner integrations, and developer experience** (auth, rate limits, versioning, documentation). netflix.wd1.mywo... +1
6. **Drive monetization / ad-tech features & measurement** (server-side ad flows, measurement pipelines). LinkedIn +1
7. **Design experiment/AB test plans and measure impact** (A/B frameworks and experiment instrumentation). Careers at Netflix
8. **Own security/DRM/license behaviors** and work with rights teams and platform constraints. jobs.dolby.com
9. **Investigate incidents & produce post-mortems** (timeline, root cause, corrective actions). showbizjobs.com
10. **Translate business metrics to technical requirements** (e.g., rebuffer → CDN/transcode policy changes). careers.paramou...

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3) Five entry-level projects — each scoped to 96 hours (12 weeks × 8 hrs/week) and designed to show technical product competence

Common constraints I followed:

- MERN-friendly (Node/Express + MongoDB + React) as primary stack — you can substitute PostgreSQL where necessary.
- Free tools first (GitHub, GitHub Pages / Vercel free tier, MongoDB Atlas free tier, Netlify/Vercel, Render free tiers, ffmpeg locally). I'll mark paid items explicitly.
- Each project shows tangible artifacts: GitHub repo + README + deployed demo, API docs (OpenAPI), runbook / release checklist, a short 5–7 minute video walkthrough and a 1-page resume bullet + metrics summary.

I list the project title, the TPM tasks it matches, outcome, tech/tools (free vs. paid), certifications that help, and a **week-by-week 12-week plan** (Mon–Thu, 2 hrs/day).

Project A — "Playback Ops Dashboard & Incident Runbook"

Why this shows TPM skills: demonstrates telemetry monitoring, incident investigation, SLA tracking, and writing runbooks — core TPM operational responsibilities (Tasks 4 & 9 above).

Desired outcome (deliverable): A deployed dashboard that ingests simulated streaming telemetry, shows KPI charts (startup time, rebuffer rate, CDN error rate), includes alerting rules, and a reproducible incident post-mortem/runbook (with RCA and remediation tasks). Provide a 5–7 minute walkthrough video and a 1-page "impact" summary for resumes.

Tech & tools (free vs paid):

- Backend: Node.js + Express (MERN). **Free.**
- DB: MongoDB Atlas free tier. **Free.**
- Telemetry/visuals: Grafana (local/docker) or use lightweight charting in React + Vega/Chart.js (both free). **Free.**
- Simulation: small Node script to push synthetic telemetry (free).
- Deployment: Vercel / Render / GitHub Pages for frontend; Render free tier for backend. **Free** (may need paid tier for advanced features, optional).
- Logging: store logs in Mongo and show sample queries. **Free.**

Certifications that help (optional): Datadog fundamentals / AWS Cloud Practitioner (paid), but not required.

Which TPM tasks it aligns with: #4 (monitor telemetry), #9 (incident post-mortem), #1 (roadmap influence via metrics).

12-week schedule (96 hrs total — 8 hrs/week)

- Weeks 1–2 (16 hrs): Project kickoff, read sample streaming KPIs, design schema (telemetry events), scaffold MERN app, basic telemetry ingestion endpoint.
- Weeks 3–4 (16 hrs): Implement simulator to push telemetry; wire backend to MongoDB; build simple REST endpoints to query metrics.
- Weeks 5–6 (16 hrs): Build React dashboard pages (charts for startup/rebuffer/CDN errors); implement basic filters/time ranges.
- Weeks 7–8 (16 hrs): Add alert rules (thresholds), write scripts that detect anomalies, add simple email/webhook stub (simulate alerts).
- Weeks 9–10 (16 hrs): Create incident scenario (simulate outage), run through RCA; draft runbook + rollback steps and acceptance criteria.
- Weeks 11–12 (16 hrs): Polish UI, write README and runbook, create deployment + demo video, produce one-page resume metrics (e.g., “built dashboard showing rebuffer reduction levers”).

Project B — “Partner API + OAuth Integration (Content Ingest Simulator)”

Why this shows TPM skills: proves ability to design API contracts, auth flows, and partner onboarding — core TPM responsibilities (Tasks 2 & 5).

Desired outcome: A documented content-ingest API (OpenAPI spec) with OAuth2 / JWT auth, a small Node Express backend that accepts JSON content metadata and mock asset URLs, a sample partner client (Node script) that authenticates and submits content, and a partner onboarding doc + API smoke Postman collection.

Tech & tools (free vs paid):

- Backend: Node.js + Express + Passport.js (JWT/OAuth). **Free.**
- DB: MongoDB Atlas free tier. **Free.**
- API docs: Swagger / OpenAPI (swagger-ui). **Free.**
- Postman collection: Postman free, or Insomnia (free). **Free.**

- Deploy: Render / Heroku free tier (Heroku free policy may vary) or Vercel serverless functions. **Free / may require small paid credits**.

Certifications helpful: OAuth fundamentals or API design courses (Coursera — paid optional). CSPO (Certified Scrum Product Owner) helps product side.

Which TPM tasks it aligns with: #2 (write API contracts), #5 (partner integrations), #3 (coordinate launches — provide onboarding docs).

12-week schedule

- Weeks 1–2: Requirements & API design; create OpenAPI spec; set up repo and skeleton backend.
- Weeks 3–4: Implement auth flow (JWT / simple OAuth simulation), token endpoints, and partner client sample.
- Weeks 5–6: Implement ingest endpoints and store metadata in Mongo; add input validation and acceptance tests.
- Weeks 7–8: Build swagger UI, Postman/Insomnia collection, and simple partner onboarding docs (step-by-step).
- Weeks 9–10: Add rate-limiting middleware (express-rate-limit), implement basic observability endpoints (health/metrics).
- Weeks 11–12: Deploy, record walkthrough, publish README with “how to integrate” and business/tech tradeoffs (latency vs security).

Project C — “Mini Transcode & HLS Manifest Pipeline (simulated)”

Why this shows TPM skills: shows you understand transcode/cdn/manifest flow and ABR concepts (Tasks 1, 4 and 8).

Desired outcome: A local pipeline that takes an input video, uses **ffmpeg** to produce multiple ABR renditions and generates an HLS manifest, serves the manifest through a small Node server, and provides a simple web player (React+hls.js) to demo ABR switching. Include a short report that explains how ABR profiles, codecs, and CDN configuration trade off cost vs experience.

Tech & tools (free vs paid):

- ffmpeg (local CLI): **Free** (open source).

- Backend: Node/Express to serve manifest / static assets. **Free.**
- Player: React front-end with hls.js. **Free.**
- Storage / CDN simulation: host static assets on GitHub Pages or a free object store; real CDN not required — document CDN configs as design notes (Free).
- Optional paid: Cloud transcode services (AWS Elastic Transcoder / MediaConvert) — **paid but optional**.

Certifications helpful: Basic video streaming / encoding refreshers (Codecademy/articles), AWS Cloud familiarity helps but optional.

Which TPM tasks it aligns with: #1 (playback & ABR strategy), #4 (monitoring), #8 (DRM/licensing — document scope and next steps).

12-week schedule

- Weeks 1–2: Install ffmpeg, run sample transcodes to produce multiple bitrate MP4s. Scaffold repo.
- Weeks 3–4: Generate HLS chunks & manifest via ffmpeg; validate manifest with hls.js locally.
- Weeks 5–6: Build Node static server that serves manifests and media; instrument simple startup/rebuffer events (client-side JS emits events to backend).
- Weeks 7–8: Build React player dashboard to show stream metrics and simulate bandwidth throttling (browser dev tools).
- Weeks 9–10: Write design doc on transcode profiles, CDN caching rules, and cost vs quality tradeoffs.
- Weeks 11–12: Polish demo, create video walkthrough, produce resume bullet and "what I would change if scale >1M viewers" section.

Project D — "Ad-tech Latency Playbook: server-side insertion & measurement"

Why this shows TPM skills: ties to monetization, ad latency, and measurement pipelines (Tasks 6, 4, 2).

Desired outcome: A small server-side ad flow simulator: request flow that simulates a client requesting an ad, measures end-to-end latency, stores metrics, and produces an analysis showing how latency impacts user experience and monetization. Include an SLA

checklist and a simple cost/benefit recommendation (e.g., caching or prefetch vs real-time bidding).

Tech & tools (free vs paid):

- Backend: Node.js + Express for ad server simulator. **Free.**
- DB: MongoDB Atlas free tier or local SQLite for metrics. **Free.**
- Frontend: React minimal UI to trigger ad requests and show latency histograms. **Free.**
- Load testing: k6 (open source) or autocannon for synthetic traffic. **Free**.
- Optional paid: Ads measurement platforms — **not required**.

Certifications helpful: Ad Tech fundamentals (IAB micro-certs — paid optional).

Which TPM tasks it aligns with: #6 (ad-tech & measurement), #4 (monitoring & SLA), #9 (post-mortem when high latency).

12-week schedule

- Weeks 1–2: Design request/response model; create simple ad request endpoint (responds with ad JSON).
- Weeks 3–4: Implement client-side ad request flow; measure latency and store in DB.
- Weeks 5–6: Add variability (simulate slow SSPs/third-party); instrument latency histograms and percentiles.
- Weeks 7–8: Run simple load tests; capture tail latency and identify bottlenecks.
- Weeks 9–10: Write SLA recommendations, add caching/prefetch prototype, measure improvement.
- Weeks 11–12: Generate final report, produce demo video, create resume blurb (e.g., “reduced tail latency X% in simulation by introducing caching/prefetch”).

Project E — “Experimentation & Feature Rollout Sandbox (A/B for recommendations)”

Why this shows TPM skills: shows ability to design experiments, implement rollout flags, and measure impact — core TPM tasks (#7, #1, #10).

Desired outcome: A small recommendation endpoint that returns two variants (A/B) based on a feature flag; implement flagging, split traffic, collect outcomes (click/consumption), and produce an experiment report with p-values or simple statistical test. Deliver a feature rollout checklist (canary → ramp → full) and A/B result dashboard.

Tech & tools (free vs paid):

- Backend: Node.js + Express + feature-flag logic (launchdarkly is paid; implement a simple in-repo flagging service or use open-source Unleash). **Unleash is free / self-hosted; implement simple custom solution—free.**
- DB: MongoDB Atlas free tier. **Free.**
- Frontend: React to show variant UI and collect events. **Free.**
- Stats: Python (pandas/scipy) or JS stats libs to compute test significance. **Free.**

Certifications helpful: Experimentation / A/B testing short course (Optimizely / Coursera — paid optional).

Which TPM tasks it aligns with: #7 (A/B/experimentation), #1 (product roadmap decisions from experiments), #10 (translate metrics to technical requirements).

12-week schedule

- Weeks 1–2: Define experiment hypothesis & metrics; scaffold backend and minimal recommender (hard-coded rules).
- Weeks 3–4: Implement feature-flagging and traffic split, instrument event capture (clicks/plays).
- Weeks 5–6: Build frontend variants for A/B; implement event ingestion pipeline.
- Weeks 7–8: Run experiment (simulate users or invite testers), collect data.
- Weeks 9–10: Analyze results (compute lift, significance), create dashboard for KPI comparison.
- Weeks 11–12: Create rollout plan, write delivery notes (acceptance criteria), finalize README and video walkthrough.

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4) Practical notes on scope & deliverables (how to show value to employers)

- **Artifacts to include for each project:** GitHub repo (README with architecture diagram), deployed demo (Vercel/Render), OpenAPI spec or Postman collection where applicable, one-page "impact" note and a 5–7 minute video demo. These are the items recruiters/hiring managers look for.
- **Resume bullets (example):** "Built a telemetry dashboard and incident runbook for simulated streaming KPIs using Node, MongoDB, and React; defined SLA thresholds and reduced simulated tail rebuffer rate by 35% in prototype." (Use metrics you actually measured in the project.)
- **How to present them in interviews:** focus on product → engineering tradeoffs, show acceptance criteria you wrote, explain how you designed tests & rollout strategy, and walk through the runbook and post-mortem.

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5) Free vs paid tool summary (quick)

- **Free / open:** Node.js, Express, React, MongoDB Atlas free tier, ffmpeg, Grafana (self-host), Unleash (self-hosted), Postman free, GitHub, Vercel/Netlify/Render free tiers, k6/autocannon.
- **Paid / optional:** AWS MediaConvert / Cloud transcode, LaunchDarkly (feature flags), commercial A/B platforms (Optimizely). These are **optional** — you can simulate the behavior for the project.

If you want, next I will:

- fetch/capture exact job postings (I already gathered the examples above) and paste the ten raw job-description text snippets I used (so you can see source language to quote in outreach or resumes), and
- tailor **one** of the five projects into a day-by-day task list for the first 4 weeks with exact commands, starter repo structure, and README template — ready for you to start Week 14.

Which of the five projects would you like me to expand into a detailed week-by-week implementation plan first? (Pick one and I'll produce the starter repo layout, sample API spec, and the exact checklist you can follow in your 2-hr blocks.)

Sources